

Xiao XUE

Email: sean.xue@connect.polyu.hk | Website: xiaoxuehci.github.io | Updated: October 2026

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Human-Computer Interaction (HCI), Responsible AI, Participatory Design, Research through Design

EDUCATION

The University of Edinburgh, UK - MSc Design Informatics

09/2020 – 08/2021

- Degree classification: **Distinction**; Advisor: **John Vines**

Relevant Modules: Analyzing Qualitative Data, The Human Factor: Working with Users, Histories and Future of Technology, Data Science for Design, Design with Data

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University - BSc (Hons) Internet & Multimedia Technologies

09/2016 – 08/2020

- Dean's Honours List (2019/ 2020) in Faculty of Engineering; Best Semester GPA Award (2019/ 2020 Semester 1,2 and 3) in the EIE Department

Relevant Modules: Object-Oriented Programming, Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition, Multimodal Human-Computer Interaction Technology, Computer Game Development

PUBLICATIONS

- Designing with Tensions: Reframing Smart Home Ecosystem UX through In-the-Wild Evidence
He, S., Liu, Y., Wang, Z., Xue, X., Zhang, X., Shi, L., & Fu, X. CHI EA 2026
- Hear Us, then Protect Us: Navigating Deepfake Scams and Safeguard Interventions with Older Adults through Participatory Design
Zhai, Y., Xue, X., Guo, Z., Jin, T., Diao, Y., & Jeung, J. CHI 2025.
- When My Car Whispers Secrets to My Home: Envisioning the Opportunities and Challenges of Human-Vehicle-Home Integrated Ecosystems through Probes
Xue, X., He, S., Chen, K., Qiao, R., Xu, W., Wang, E., Zhao, Y., & Fu, X. CHI EA 2025.
- A Card-Based Co-Design Toolkit for Exploring Smart Material Applications with Multiple Stakeholders: A Case Study on Automotive Interior Design
Yu, T., Wang, X., Lu, Y., Yu, K., Yao, X., Deng, W., Li, Z., Li, X., Xue, X., Yang, Y., Guo, Y., Yao, Y., Liu, G., & Mi, H. DIS 2025.
- Who Should Hold Control? Rethinking Empowerment in Home Automation among Cohabitants through the Lens of Co-Design
Xue, X., Li, X., Jia, B., Du, J., & Fu, X. CHI 2024.
- Beyond Driving: Envisioning Activities in Future Autonomous Vehicles through Experience-Centered Design
Chen, K., Xue, X., Liu, X., Tan, R., Speed, C., Lee, K. M., & Lv, C. 2026. arXiv preprint, arXiv:2609.30076. Submitted to Journal of Transport Geography.

Manuscripts Under Review

- “AI That Works for Workers, Not Bosses”: Co-speculating Workplace GenAI with Knowledge Workers
Xue, X., Li, K., Ji, Y., Long, D., Ma, R., Chen, R., & Fu, X. Submitted to CHI 2027.
- When Users Redefine Protection: Participatory Enactment and Co-Design for Security, Safety, and Privacy in Romantic AI
Ma, R., He, S., Xue, X., Jenkins, A. D. G., Zhan, X., & Such, J. Submitted to CHI 2027.
- Beyond Shared Access: Understanding Participation around Generative AI in Secondary-School Group Work
Zha, S., Xue, X., Liu, W., Fu, X., & Xu, Y. Submitted to CHI 2027.

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Co-speculating Workplace GenAI with Knowledge Workers

2026

- Used co-speculation with 16 knowledge workers to reimagine workplace GenAI around workers' interests, examining what support they value and whether it can hold when worker and organizational interests diverge.
- First author; led study conception and design, participant recruitment, workshop material development, literature review, data analysis, and manuscript writing; co-facilitated the workshops.

User-defined Protection in Romantic AI

2026

- Explored how romantic AI users define security, safety, and privacy through participatory enactment and co-design, examining how imposed safeguards can conflict with consent, relational continuity, and user agency.
- Collaboratively designed the study protocol and enactment activities; supported facilitation in selected workshops and collaborated on qualitative analysis.

Participation around GenAI in Secondary-School Group Work

2026

- Examined collaboration around shared GenAI among secondary-school students from Beijing and Tibet, distinguishing shared access from consequential participation to inform collaborative learning design.
- Led workshop design and developed the research materials; co-organized the workshop, collaborated on qualitative analysis, and contributed to manuscript writing.

Beyond Driving: Envisioning Activities in Autonomous Vehicles

2025

- Combined travel diaries, scenario scripting, and mixed-reality enactments to investigate non-driving activities in autonomous vehicles, showing how these activities form connected sequences shaped by everyday contexts before departure and after arrival.
- Designed the study procedure; collaborated on workshop facilitation and interviews, and contributed to data analysis and manuscript writing.

Exploring Deepfake Scams and Safeguards with Older Adults

2024

- Worked with 10 older adults to interpret deepfake scams and critique proposed safeguards, identifying expectations for protection that respects autonomy, supports digital literacy, and shares responsibility across individuals, platforms, and public authorities.
- Designed and facilitated participatory workshops using simulated scam videos and provocative safeguarding concepts; contributed to reflexive thematic analysis.

Rethinking Empowerment in Shared Home Automation through Co-Design

2023

- Examined how cohabitants negotiate home automation through card-based co-design, showing how automation can empower some residents while marginalizing others and identifying opportunities for perceptible, participatory, and contestable control.
- First author; designed co-design materials, conducted workshops, and led content/thematic analysis and manuscript writing.

WORK & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Intern – The Future Laboratory, Tsinghua University

10/2022-Present

Mentored by Dr. Xinyi Fu

- Contributed to HCI/design research, academic writing, grant preparation, and scholarly service, including living-lab coordination, demonstrations, academic/industry visits, and research community engagement.
- Led and contributed to 10 peer-reviewed publications and research manuscripts through study design, analysis, and manuscript writing.

Research Assistant – Nanyang Technological University

05/2019-08/2019

Mentored by Prof. Perry Ping Shum

- Worked with computer vision researchers on an emotion recognition system and AR presentation host for an interactive Xperience Room environment.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewer: CHI 2025–2027; Foundations of Digital Games (FDG) 2026; GamiFIN 2022–2023; ICHEC 2025

Program Committee: Chinese CHI 2024

EXTRA-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES & VOLUNTARY WORK

- Dr. Y.K. Ching Memorial Scholarship, 2017/18.
- External Vice President, Chinese Mainland Students' Association, PolyU, 2017-2018; sourced over HKD 300,000 in sponsorship and organized an inter-university singing competition with 700+ attendees.
- Volunteer teacher, HeartFire 17th voluntary teaching trip, 2018; completed 200 hours of teaching and activity facilitation for 100+ students in Hunan, China.

SKILLS

Qualitative methods: interviews, thematic analysis, content analysis, reflexive thematic analysis.

Design research: participatory design, speculative design, and enactment.

Technical skills: Python, Java, C/C++, SQL, PHP; Unity prototyping; Adobe CC; 3ds Max.

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native), English (professional), Cantonese (intermediate).